FACT SHEET

Banwag at a Glance

A beacon for peace in the Bangsamoro — Parang, Maguindanao del Norte, Philippines

The name

Banwag is a Cebuano word meaning “beacon,” “illumination,” or “enlightenment.” The structure was conceived to hold space for safe conversations and gatherings among Muslim, Christian, and Lumad communities — a beacon of hope that peace is possible.

Awards — Good Design Award Philippines 2026

- **Grand Prix Malasakit Award** — the program’s highest prize, given to the Gold Awardee whose design best advances the UN SDGs and quality of life
- **Gold Award** — Place Making category
- **Red Award**

Jury citation: *“(Banwag) is among the most direct expressions of malasakit the award has seen.”*

The structure

Item	Detail
Type	Trimmed (ribbed) lamella dome, permanent outdoor installation
Location	Parang, Maguindanao del Norte, BARMM, Mindanao, Philippines
Dimensions	15 × 15 × 9.5 m · 120 sqm floor area · single level
Classification	Recreational / community gathering space
Materials	Natural bamboo poles (Bambusa blumeana), high-performance marine outdoor fabric, stainless steel connectors, wire rope, nuts and bolts; reinforced concrete slab foundation
Structure	127 bamboo poles across 7 structural layers plus top; 26 anchor points; patented SIP steel node connections
Assembly	2.5 weeks, no heavy machinery, zero specialized drawings on site — SIP’s “Build by Numbers” system: every pole digitally mapped, numbered, and pre-cut
Sourcing & labor	Every pole sourced from local farmers; assembled entirely by local hands
Lighting	Multi-colored LED scheme turns the lattice into a beacon at night; colors mark different celebrations and communities

Design symbolism

- Uniform geometry: harmonic plurality — the dome echoes both the vaulted forms of early Christian cathedrals and the radial symmetry and tessellation of Islamic architecture (references: the Blue Mosque, the Pantheon)
- Six identical entrances distributed equally around the perimeter: everyone is welcome from whatever direction they have traveled — no hierarchy of entry

- Bamboo as material and metaphor: resilient in typhoons because it bends — strength through flexibility

The people behind it

- **Conceived by** the Sarmiento family / PS Group of Companies, together with Studio Impossible Projects (Rick and Jasper)
- **Designed & built by** Studio Impossible Projects (Rotterdam & the Philippines)
- **In memory of** Bambina Sarmiento, who first saw what bamboo could build, and Pablo Sarmiento, founder of PS Group

Key dates

- June 2024 — Banwag completed and inaugurated in Parang
- June 29, 2026 — Good Design Award Philippines 2026 winners announced: three awards including the Grand Prix Malasakit — coinciding with World Industrial Design Day (2026 theme: resilience) and founder Pablo Sarmiento's birthday